Che Li

Concert Pianist, Educator, Collaborative Pianist

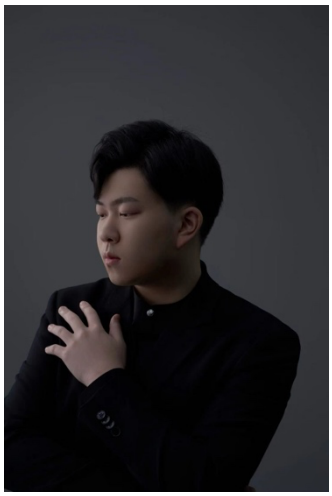
2026 PRESS KIT

Contact Info:

Phone: 8578695485 **Email: liche6549@gmail.com**

Artist Bio:

Pianist Che Li, a native of Zhejiang, China, has been an active performer in both the United States and China. In 2016, he performed the Grieg Piano Concerto with the Shanghai Philharmonic Orchestra in Shanghai (China). In 2019, he performed Chopin's Piano Concerto No. 2 with the Santa Monica Symphony Orchestra at the Colburn Conservatory of Music in Los Angeles. In 2023, Che Li performed the Tchaikovsky Piano Concerto No.1 with the Mercury Orchestra at the New England Conservatory (Boston, Massachusetts). He has appeared as solo recitalist at the Wenzhou (China) University School of Music, at the Cadillac Shanghai Concert Hall in Shanghai (China), at the Hefei (China) Grand Theater—as part of the "Yangtze River Delta New Shining Stars" series.



In 2026, Che won the first prize of the Boston University Richmond Piano Competition. In 2024, Che received the first prize of the IX Krystian Tkaczewski International Piano Competition in Poland. That same year, he won the second prize of the XV Chopin Piano Competition in Hartford and the Special Liszt Prize in San Francisco International Piano Competition. In 2023, he won the first prize in Fou Ts'ong International Concerto Competition. In 2017, he won the first prize in the National Youth Piano Open Competition at Shanghai Conservatory of Music and second place in the German Grotrian Competition in China. He is also a prize winner of numerous other competitions including the Irmler International Piano Competition in Qingdao, China, the Xinghai National Piano Competition, and the Shenzhen Piano Competition.

Che Li began piano studies at the age of four, taught by his mother. At age 12, he was accepted into the Shanghai Conservatory of Music, where he studied with Professor Yunlin Yang. In 2019, he entered the New England Conservatory of Music to study with Haesun Paik for bachelor's degree. In 2025, Che graduated from the New England Conservatory of Music where he studied with Alexander Korsantia and obtained a Master of Music. He is now pursuing an Artist Diploma in Piano Performance with Pavel Nersessian at Boston University College of Fine Arts.

Review by *The Boston Musical Intelligencer*

Glamorous Mercury and Li

"2023 Fou-Ts'ong International Competition winner, pianist Che Li, a Chinese-born Recent graduate from New England Conservatory of Music, joined conductor Channing Yu and the Mercury Orchestra at Jordan Hall for the 1879 version of the Tchaikovsky's First Piano concerto Saturday night in the stimulating final concert of the Foundation for Chinese Performing Arts's 2023 summer festival....

Right from the introduction of the concerto, one sensed the majestic, yet charming grandeur in Li's pianism. Backed by the vast and cascading orchestra, his (much-preferred) rolled chords swept over us emotionally and sumptuously....

Li gave an immaculate and pristine take of the first theme; the second and third themes sounded sentimental and ever flowing. Li punched strong, spotless octaves. In polyphony, Li brought out the varying voices with tasteful clarity, seemingly intertwined and separate all at once. Li's cadenza felt a little reserved, but again, the brilliant octaves and the long, weeping melodies glistened....

Conjuring booming flowers and vast grass fields, flutist Anne Kim opened the second movement in gorgeous tone and phrasing, inviting Li for a journey. During the first theme, Li delivered with clarity and high-class sentiments....

The third movement opens with another Ukrainian folk tune. Though at times mechanical, Li's thrilling octaves and stubborn, precise rhythm danced with the orchestra.... The few bars of added sequences in this version's orchestration (which only exists in the first two versions) blurred the already exciting finale. Before the last molto meno mosso, the octaves in the piano remained in the same register, different from the more exciting jumping octaves that we know and love today. These stale octaves needed a different treatment, but it seemed as though Li played these with the feel of the jumping ones. No matter, the music erupted soon thereafter, building to a thunderous conclusion. With rapture, the crowd called Li back four times."

August 29, 2023

By *Chi Wei Lo*